VOC, he added. Blind to his own prejudice, Wynch expressed concern about the outcry against the government if the company were to be wound up. Without being asked, he proffered gratuitous advice that SSNCo had better engage some experts to make a report about the situation and work out a strategy to hang on until BI was forced to make room for them.

What was the source of Wynch's newfound love for SSNCo? 'They have begun to realize that they have been swindled and ruined by Chidambaram Pillay but they dare not make public confession of the fact.' This was nothing but a figment of his imagination. Wynch also broached the idea of the government appointing a board of conciliation between SSNCo and BI. He promised that the latter would do everything possible to help the Swadeshi company save face apart from contributing 'handsomely towards a fund for relief of any shareholders who might be shown to have suffered severe losses'.

Why would the company agree to such a bail out? 'The Swadeshi Company are not in a position to make terms themselves. Their one weapon is the howl they can raise throughout the country and the consequent trouble they can give Government.' If the government was willing to constitute such a board of conciliation, Wynch promised to rally some of the Swadeshi directors to place themselves at the board's command. No doubt Wynch was mischievously trying to drive a wedge in the already existing fissures in the Swadeshi's company's management and ensure that it collapsed under the weight of its contradictions.

The chief secretary's first reaction to Wynch's long epistle and suggestion for appointment of a board of conciliation was to reject it outright: let the Swadeshi company come 'to grief in its own way and time', he said heartlessly. On second thought, he saw an opportunity to submit its accounts to public scrutiny and cover up the government's underhand methods to scuttle the company. He said, 'It will be a further immense political advantage if one result of Government's intervention should be to prove that, as Mr Wynch says, the Swadeshi Co "have been swindled and ruined by Chidambaram Pillay".' If the Swadeshi company passed a formal resolution inviting government's intervention, the government could initiate